

The Siege of Ironhold

A tale of craft, coordination and judgment

The Iron Tyrant approaches Ironhold, the last stronghold of the free lands. His siege engines shake the roads. Behind the walls, six guilds must build a force of Titan's Bastion war golems before the final assault.

The Emberborn Smiths forge the frames. The Gearwright's Consortium builds the engines. Together their components enter the Hammer and Anvil Guild, which makes each core subassembly. At the same time, the Arcane Weavers enchant the armor. The Titanwrights combine that armor with the subassembly. Finally, the Order of the Unerring Gaze inspects each Titan before it can defend the walls.

Every completed unit is one Titan. A slower guild still makes one whole unit when its capacity and supplies permit. It never makes half a Titan.

Three cycles before the assault

Early Dawn: rounds 1-5. Learn how the guilds depend on one another.

Fires of Noon: rounds 6-10. Review delays and improve coordination.

Twilight of Battle: rounds 11-15. Complete and inspect the Titans before time expires. All six guilds operate in every round. The cycle names do not change the penalty rates.

The Council's terms

Each guild starts with **10 gold**. Before round 1, the Council announces a whole-game target of approved Titans. The class may instead use a practice game with no target and compare completed output. Gold, inventory and outstanding work carry across the three cycles.

A green signal means the local process is healthy. Yellow asks others to anticipate a delay. Red stops an unsafe or failed operation so it can be addressed. A truthful warning protects the factory. A warning is never a separate fine.

If any guild's gold reaches zero or falls below it, the whole factory fails. If all guilds survive through round 15 and meet the announced target, Ironhold is defended. Only then is the richest guild named Master Guild. Ties share the title. In practice mode, report output and remaining gold without claiming a target victory.

The challenge is to protect the common mission while using scarce resources well. Will the guilds act together, or will local decisions leave Ironhold undefended?

Rules: use Game Rule Book, revised edition 3.0. This story introduces the setting; it adds no separate penalties or dice rules.